

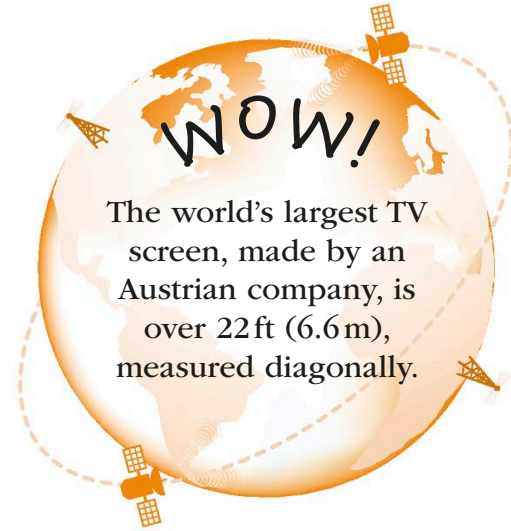
Big screens

Most items of technology get smaller as they are developed. Think of how large the earliest phones, computers, or cameras were. Television screens have done the opposite and become bigger. The earliest TV screens were about the size of those on laptop computers. The latest models today are like mini movie screens.

Early household television

- **What?** Telefunken FE-1
- **Who?** Telefunken
- **Where and when?** Germany, 1934

The earliest TV sets used John Logie Baird's mechanical system, which was scrapped in the 1930s when the first electronic televisions were made in Germany. France, Britain, and the US soon followed with their own models. Early TVs were large pieces of wooden furniture with small, 12-inch (30-cm) screens.



Color television

- **What?** Westinghouse H840CK15
- **Who?** Westinghouse
- **Where and when?** US, 1954

Although the first color broadcasts were made in the US in 1951, Westinghouse's color television set was not available to the public until three years later. Other companies produced color TVs, too, but they sold slowly because they were so expensive and there were few programs in color. It was not until the 1970s, when all programming was in color, that color television really took off.



Color television, 1970s

Modern-age television

- **What?** Philco Predicta
- **Who?** Philco
- **Where and when?** Philadelphia, US, 1959

Televisions did not stay in their heavy wooden cases for long. Improved technology allowed them to become more movable and to include new ideas. This Philco Predicta, for example, had the world's first swivel screen. In the 1950s, TVs were still a luxury and designers wanted to make them look as futuristic as possible.

